

Ralph Tells a Story

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Source: `Ralph Tells a Story -- by Abigail Hanlon .pdf` (40 PDF pages; story on PDF pages 10-36)

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> Internal school working copy prepared from a school-accessible PDF. Keep with the restricted book files. Do not publish this transcript in GitHub, Supabase, or the public progress viewer.

Nothing ever happens to Ralph. So every day when it's time to write stories, Ralph thinks really hard. He stares at his paper. He stares at the ceiling. But he has no stories!

And the kids in my class were always finding them.

After that, | decided to hide my Halloween candy in my bed. ... ran so fast that she caught up with the ice-cream truck. ... | ran down the hallway with underwear on my head... The dentist forgot to give me a toothbrush!

But every day at writing time, I thought hard. I stared at my paper. I stared at the ceiling. I could not write a story.

"Then Grandma gave me 2 cup of coffee", "Don't tell ... your mother."

So I looked for other things to do. "Can | go to the bathroom? (help the lunch) ladies?" I roamed the hallways. I tried everything.

Then one day, after getting sent back to my desk, I begged Daisy for help. "I can't write a story because NOTHING happens to me!" "Are you kidding" she said. "I've written a ton of stories about you!"

She began pulling her stories out of her desk. "Look at this one," she said. "Remember the time you let me brush your hair? And this one! Remember the time you knocked down all the crayons? Oh and remember the time you painted your nails with a black marker?" I thought, Pll never be a great writer like Daisy.

Then Daisy stapled all her stories together. Click click! "Wow!" she said. "This book is already thirteen pages!" Click click! ... I was really good at stapling. "But you have nothing to staple!" said Daisy. "You have to find a story first"

So I looked for stories out the window ... in my desk. And when my teacher wasn't looking, I looked for stories on the floor.

But still no stories.

Lying under my desk reminded me of lying in the grass at the park. I closed my eyes and imagined I was at the park . . . just like that time a little inchworm crawled on my knee. The sun was shining right into my eyes. Squinting, I picked up the wiggly inchworm and looked at it close-up.

And that's when my teacher found me. "What's your story about?" she asked. ... "Wonderful!" she said. "I can't wait to read what you wrote." But there was no inchworm story!

I sat down and tried to write about the inchworm, but right away I got stuck. "Do you know any inchworm stories?" I asked Daisy. She just rolled her eyes and kept on writing.

And then my teacher said: "Come to the rug! Time to share!"

"Ralph, why don't you go first?" said the teacher. I pretended that I had lost my paper.

It didn't work. I walked to the front of the rug. It took a long time. "I was at the park," I said. "An inchworm crawled on my knee."

It was quiet.

My heart went: Thump. Thump. Thump. Thump.

That's when I looked at Daisy. ... feel squishy,

And then everybody started asking me questions. "Did ... touch it?", "Did ... let you keep it?", "Did it ..."]

Wait a minute! | thought. SOMETHING DID HAPPEN WITH THAT INCHWORM! "... built ... house ...", "... of a sudden ...", "... CRAZY ...", "'Come on, boy,' L said ... '... Ralphie ... the inchwormy? ...", "And we spen... rest ... noon ... nothing ... gether.", "The End."]

Everybody clapped and cheered. "Show the picture, Ralph," someone said. ... wonderful ...

I wasn't embarrassed anymore so I did.

That was last year. This year I write stories all the time. I keep ... finding stories everywhere. This book might be too thick ...

Writing Tips from Ralph 1. Get Comfortable. ... 2. You can always ... write about what you had for breakfast. ... chocolate ...

- The opening spreads show Ralph staring at blank paper and ceiling while classmates' handwritten stories (Halloween candy, ice-cream truck, underwear hallway run, dentist) fill the pages around him.
- The middle spreads follow Ralph roaming the hallways, begging Daisy for help, admiring her thirteen-page stapled book, and hunting for stories out the window, in his desk, and on the floor.
- The park-memory spreads show Ralph under his desk imagining the grass, the sun, and the wiggly inchworm on his knee, then freezing when the teacher asks what his story is about.
- The rug-sharing spreads show Ralph's long walk to the front, his two-sentence telling, his thumping heart, and classmates' hands shooting up with questions that grow his story.
- The closing spreads show the cheering class, Ralph showing his picture, and the now-prolific writer Ralph with his too-thick book of stories plus his writing tips.

Page map: back-cover summary (PDF page 2); classmates' handwritten stories (PDF pages 10, 12-13); typeset narration (PDF pages 11, 14-28, 34-36); handwritten rug questions and story pages (PDF pages 26, 29-33); Writing Tips end matter (PDF page 37).

Removed from the story flow (book prose preserved above; scan substitutions "|" for I and "Pll" for I'll kept as embedded):

- "" label after the opening lines.
- "" label; the legible fragments stay in the story.
- Double-page-spread label (PDF page 12) -- legible fragments kept: "Then Grandma gave me 2 cup of coffee", "Don't tell ... your mother."
- "qu" rendered as "quiet" in the story.
- "" after "... feel squishy," (rug scene).
- Children's-questions label with legible fragments kept: "Did ... touch it?", "Did ... let you keep it?", "Did it ...".

- Handwritten-story-pages label (PDF pages 30-33); legible fragments kept, including inner reconstructions "sphen", "gether", "'Come on, boy,' L said", "... Ralphie ... the inchwormy?", "CRAZY", "The End."
- "" after the "... wonderful ..." line and after "This book might be too thick ...".
- Writing-tips end-matter label (PDF page 37); legible fragments kept: "1. Get Comfortable. ... 2. You can always ... write about what you had for breakfast. ... chocolate ...".

Story text transcribed from the embedded text layer (PDF pages 10-36), joined across line breaks. The scan's OCR is uneven: typeset narration pages (11, 14-28, 34-36) read coherently with minor substitutions ("I" for I, "Pll" for I'll), while the handwritten story pages (10, 12-13, 26, 29-33, 37) are heavily garbled in the layer and are represented above by legible fragments with explicit garble flags. Cover and publishing matter (pages 1-2, 5), copyright and cataloguing data (page 6), the dedication (page 7), library stamps, the author biography (page 39) and closing matter (pages 38, 40) are not included as story prose. Pixel-level visual verification against the rendered scans has not yet been completed -- my image-reading tool is currently unavailable, so please check the transcript against the PDF before treating it as final.